able to take a couple of good photographs for use in the book. For this, I am very grateful to him. I am also grateful to Prakash Singh, former DGP UP and DG BSF, for having permitted me to quote one of his posts, details of which appears in the Preface.

G.S. Chawla, former senior correspondent of the *Indian Express,* shared with me some of his experiences to help me better understand what had been happening on the ground. I am grateful to G.S. Pandher, former DG BPR&D and DIG of BSF at Amritsar when Operation Blue Star was launched, and to M.P.S. Aulakh, former DGP Punjab, who held the crucial post of assistant director, Intelligence Bureau, Amritsar, from 1982 to 1985, for the information provided by them.

Special thanks are due to my friend and IPS batchmate Ratan Sahgal for being very helpful during Indira Gandhi's two visits to the US in 1982 and 1983. I am also grateful to my IPS batchmate Chaman Lal who provided me with some very useful information about the functioning of the Punjab Police during the two-year period he was posted as DIG BSF (Border) and Punjab Police. Another of my IPS batchmates, P.S. Bawa, helped me understand the functioning of the Delhi police and their role in the November 1984 anti-Sikh pogrom. My special thanks also to Dr Mohinder Singh, director, Bhai Veer Singh Sahitya Sadan (BVSS), New Delhi, for lending me books from his personal library, which proved useful in writing some portions of Chapter 1. He also procured some very useful photographs which have been included in this book. Ambassador K.C. Singh (Retd), who still remembered my brief conversation with him in September 1983 in New York, has kindly shared with me crucial information that came to his knowledge while he was posted as deputy secretary in the President's secretariat in November 1984. My gratitude to him for it.

Last, but not the least, my special thanks to the very energetic Swati Chopra, executive editor at HarperCollins, without whose enthusiastic support this project would not have taken off, to begin with. She was a great support throughout the writing process and made many valuable suggestions at the editing stage.